

Items from the Situational Test of Emotional Understanding (STEU)**Reference:**

MacCann, C., & Roberts, R. D. (2008). New Paradigms for Assessing Emotional Intelligence: Theory and Data. *Emotion*, 8, 540-551.

Description of test. This test assesses emotion understanding, a key component of emotional intelligence. In each item, the test-taker is required to choose which of five emotions is most likely to result from an emotional situation.

Test development. Roseman's (2001) appraisal theory was as the basis for item construction and scoring of the STEU. For more information on test development, see MacCann and Roberts (2008).

Reliability. This Cronbach's alpha for this test is .71 (MacCann & Roberts, 2008)

Validity. This assessment demonstrates convergent validity, correlating with a measure of emotional management ($r = .70$, $N = 112$). Test scores predict lower levels of anxiety, depression, and stress ($r = -.25$, $-.15$, and $-.17$, respectively, $N = 149$). This test also produced significant correlations with a Stories test ($r = .40$, $N = 200$), vocabulary ($r = .49$, $N = 200$), agreeableness, ($r = .16$, $N = 200$), an External Oriented Thinking Alexithymia Scale ($r = -.38$, $N = 200$), Psychology grade ($r = .42$, $N = 200$) and college grade-point-average ($r = .37$, $N = 200$).

Instructions

The following questions each describe a situation, and ask you to choose which of five emotions is most likely to result from that situation.

Here is an example:

Clara receives a gift. Clara is most likely to feel?

(a) happy (b) angry (c) frightened (d) bored (e) hungry

If you think Clara would feel happy, you would mark option A and then move to the next question. There are 42 questions.

Test items

1. A pleasant experience ceases unexpectedly and there is not much that can be done about it. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Ashamed
- (b) Distressed
- (c) Angry
- (d) Sad
- (e) Frustrated

2. Xavier completes a difficult task on time and under budget. *Xavier is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Surprise
- (b) Pride
- (c) Relief
- (d) Hope
- (e) Joy

3. An irritating neighbor of Eve's moves to another state. *Eve is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Regret
- (b) Hope
- (c) Relief
- (d) Sadness
- (e) Joy

4. There is great weather on the day Jill is going on an out-door picnic. *Jill is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Pride
- (b) Joy
- (c) Relief
- (d) Guilt
- (e) Hope

5. Regret is most likely to occur when?

- (a) Events are unexpected
- (b) You have caused something you didn't want to happen and cannot change it
- (c) Circumstances have caused something you didn't want to happen
- (d) You have caused something you didn't want to happen and are trying to change it
- (e) Events are getting beyond your control

6. Edna's workmate organizes a goodbye party for Edna, who is going on holidays. *Edna is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Surprise
- (b) Gratitude
- (c) Pride
- (d) Hope
- (e) Relief

7. Something unpleasant is happening. Neither the person involved, nor anyone else can make it stop. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Guilty
- (b) Distressed
- (c) Sad
- (d) Scared
- (e) Angry

8. If the current situation continues, Denise's employer will probably be able to move her job to a location much closer to her home, which she really wants. *Denise is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Distress
- (b) Joy
- (c) Surprise
- (d) Hope
- (e) Fear

9. Song finds out that a friend of hers has borrowed money from others to pay urgent bills, but has in fact used the money for less serious purposes. *Song is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Anger
- (b) Excitement
- (c) Contempt
- (d) Shame
- (e) Horror

10. Somebody is most likely to feel surprised after?

- (a) Something unexpected happens.
- (b) Something unfamiliar happens.
- (c) Something unusual happens.
- (d) Something scary happens.
- (e) Something silly happens.

11. Leya works as a trouble-shooter. She is presented with a standard looking problem but cannot work out how to solve it. *Leya is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Confused
- (b) Frustrated
- (c) Surprised
- (d) Relieved
- (e) Distressed

12. Charles is meeting a friend to see a movie. The friend is very late and they are not in time to make it to the movie. *Charles is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Depressed
- (b) Frustrated
- (c) Angry
- (d) Contemptuous
- (e) Distressed

13. Rashid needs to meet a quota before his performance review. There is only a small change that he will be able to do so and there isn't much he can do to improve the outcome. *Rashid is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Irritated
- (b) Scared
- (c) Distressed
- (d) Sad
- (e) Hopeful

14. Someone believes that another person harmed them on purpose. There is not a lot that can be done to make things better. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Dislike
- (b) Rage
- (c) Jealousy
- (d) Surprise
- (e) Anxiety

15. Phil's workmate Bart asks Phil to lie for him about money Bart has been stealing from the company. Phil does not agree. *Phil is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Excitement
- (b) Anger
- (c) Horror
- (d) Contempt
- (e) Shame

16. Jim enjoys spending Saturdays playing with his children in the park. This year they have sporting activities on Saturdays and cannot go to the park with him any more. *Jim is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Angry
- (b) Sad
- (c) Frustrated
- (d) Distressed
- (e) Ashamed

17. If all goes well, then it's fairly likely that Derek's house will increase in value. *Derek is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Distress
- (b) Fear
- (c) Surprise
- (d) Joy
- (e) Hope

18. Sheila's workmate intentionally does not give Sheila some important information about applying for a raise. *Sheila is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Depressed
- (b) Contemptuous
- (c) Frustrated
- (d) Angry
- (e) Distressed

19. Megan is looking to buy a house. Something happened and she felt regret. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) She didn't make an offer on a house she wanted, and now she is trying to find out if it is too late.
- (b) She found a house she liked that she didn't think she would find.
- (c) She couldn't make an offer on a house she liked because the bank didn't get her the money in time.
- (d) She didn't make an offer on a house she liked and now someone else has bought it.
- (e) She made an offer on a house and is waiting to see if it is accepted.

20. Mary was working at her desk. Something happened that caused her to feel surprised. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) Her work-mate told a silly joke.
- (b) She was working on a new task she hadn't dealt with before.
- (c) She found some results that were different from what she thought they would be.
- (d) She realized she would not be able to complete her work.
- (e) She had to do a task she didn't normally do at work.

21. Garry's small business is attracting less and less clients and he can't tell why. There doesn't seem to be anything he can do to help matters. *Garry is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Scared
- (b) Angry
- (c) Sad
- (d) Guilty
- (e) Distressed

22. Someone thinks that another person has deliberately caused something good to happen to them. *They are most likely to feel?*
- (a) Hope
 - (b) Pride
 - (c) Gratitude
 - (d) Surprise
 - (e) Relief
23. Kevin has been working at his current job for a few years. Out of the blue, he finds that he will receive a promotion. *Kevin is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Pride
 - (b) Relief
 - (c) Joy
 - (d) Hope
 - (e) Guilt
24. By their own actions, a person reaches a goal they wanted to reach. *The person is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Joy
 - (b) Hope
 - (c) Relief
 - (d) Pride
 - (e) Surprise
25. An unwanted situation becomes less likely or stops altogether. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Regret
 - (b) Hope
 - (c) Joy
 - (d) Sadness
 - (e) Relief
26. Hasad tries to use his new mobile phone. He has always been able to work out how to use different appliances, but he cannot get the phone to function. *Hasad is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Distressed
 - (b) Confused
 - (c) Surprised
 - (d) Relieved
 - (e) Frustrated
27. Dorian's friend is ill and coughs all over him without bothering to turn away or cover his mouth. *Dorian is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Anxiety
 - (b) Dislike
 - (c) Surprise
 - (d) Jealousy
 - (e) Rage

28. Although she has been careful to avoid all risk factors, Tina has contracted cancer. There is only a small chance that the cancer will be benign and nothing Tina does now can make a difference.

Tina is most likely to feel?

- (a) Scared
- (b) Distressed
- (c) Irritated
- (d) Sad
- (e) Hopeful

29. Quan and his wife are talking about what happened to them that day. Something happened that caused Quan to feel surprised. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) His wife talked a lot, which did not usually happen.
- (b) His wife talked about things that were different to what they usually discussed.
- (c) His wife told him that she might have some bad news.
- (d) His wife told Quan some news that was not what he thought it would be.
- (e) His wife told a funny story.

30. An upcoming event might have bad consequences. Nothing much can be done to alter this. *The person involved would be most likely to feel?*

- (a) Sad
- (b) Irritated
- (c) Distressed
- (d) Scared
- (e) Hopeful

31. It is clear that somebody will get what they want. *They are most likely to feel?*

- (a) Pride
- (b) Relief
- (c) Joy
- (d) Hope
- (e) Guilt

32. By chance, a situation arises where there is the possibility that a person will get what they want. *The person is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Distress
- (b) Hope
- (c) Surprise
- (d) Joy
- (e) Fear

33. A supervisor who is unpleasant to work for leaves Alfonso's work. *Alfonso is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Joy
- (b) Hope
- (c) Regret
- (d) Relief
- (e) Sadness

34. The nature of Sara's job changes due to unpredictable factors and she no longer gets to do the portions of her work that she most enjoyed. *Sara is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Ashamed
- (b) Sad
- (c) Angry
- (d) Distressed
- (e) Frustrated

35. Leila has been unable to sleep well lately and there are no changes in her life that might indicate why. *Leila is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Angry
- (b) Scared
- (c) Sad
- (d) Distressed
- (e) Guilty

36. A person feels they have control over a situation. The situation turns out badly for no particular reason. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Confused
- (b) Relieved
- (c) Surprised
- (d) Frustrated
- (e) Distressed

37. Someone believes another person has deliberately caused something good to stop happening to them. However, they feel they can do something about it. *They are most likely to feel?*

- (a) Angry
- (b) Contemptuous
- (c) Distress
- (d) Depressed
- (e) Frustrated

38. The new manager at Enid's work changes everyone's hours to a less flexible work pattern, leaving no room for discussion. *Enid is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Dislike
- (b) Rage
- (c) Jealousy
- (d) Surprise
- (e) Anxiety

39. Someone believes that another person has caused harm to them, due to that person's bad character. They think they can probably handle the situation though. *The harmed person is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Contempt
- (b) Anger
- (c) Horror
- (d) Excitement
- (e) Shame

40. Pete gets home late, after his favorite TV show has ended. Pete's partner has taped the show for him. *Pete is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Surprise
- (b) Hope
- (c) Pride
- (d) Relief
- (e) Gratitude

41. Matthew has been at his current job for six months. Something happened that caused him to feel regret. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) He did not apply for a position he wanted, and has found out that someone else less qualified got the job.
- (b) He did not apply for a position he wanted, and has started looking for a similar position.
- (c) He found out that opportunities for promotion have dried up.
- (d) He found out that he didn't get a position he thought he would get.
- (e) He didn't hear about a position he could have applied for and now it is too late.

42. Penny's hockey team trained hard and won the championship. *Penny is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Hope
- (b) Pride
- (c) Relief
- (d) Joy
- (e) Surprise

Scoring the STEU in SPSS

The following SPSS syntax can be used to score the 42 items of the STEU. This assumes that the variable names for the items are STEU01, STEU02, STEU03, STEU04 etc up to STEU42, and that the responses are coded as A=1, B=2, C=3, D=5, and E=5.

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